Project Tracker: how to use it

UCalgary Racing · reading the plan, updating your parts, and the weekly routine

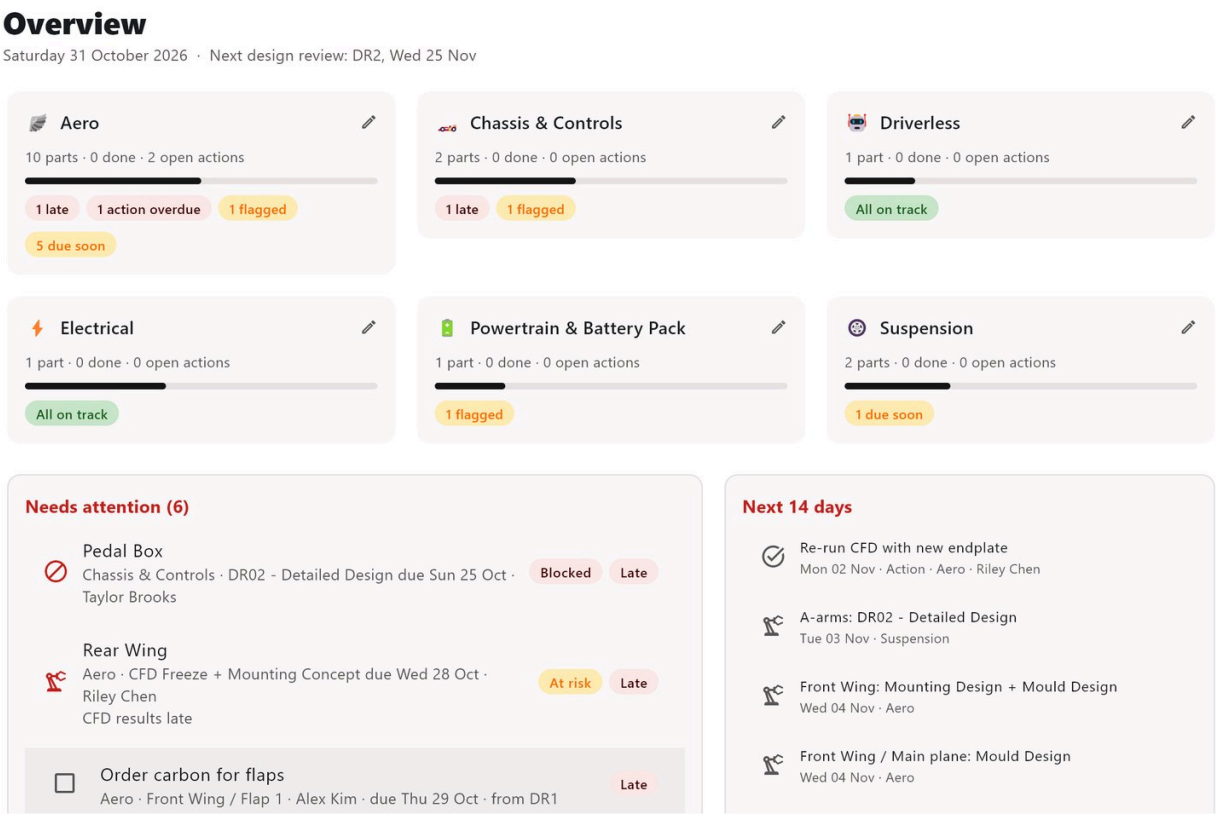
The idea

- Every subteam's plan is an Excel file on the team SharePoint. The app is a friendlier window onto those files. Everyone can **see** everything; only a subteam's lead can **change** that subteam.
- Each part moves through **gates** (design reviews, freezes, manufacturing...), each with a due date. A part is **late** when a gate it's working on is past its due date.
- Edits save straight to SharePoint. Press ↻ (bottom of the left bar) to pick up other people's latest changes.

Getting around

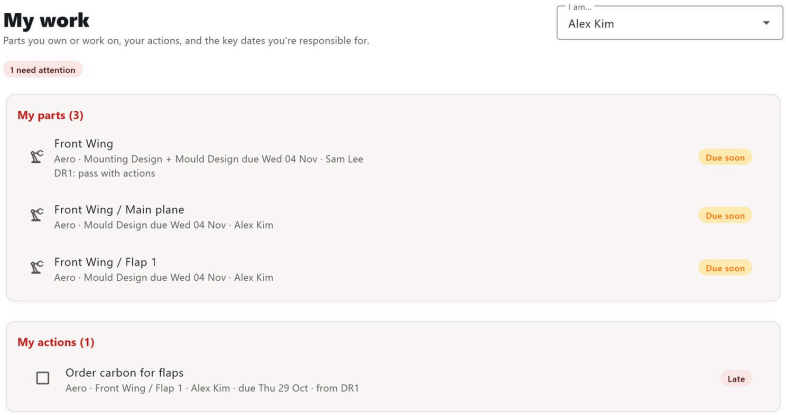
The bar on the left has **Overview**, **My work**, **Calendar**, **Key dates** and one tab per subteam. At the bottom: ↻ reload, ☾ light/dark, and the folder button (which tracker folder you're looking at). Clicking almost anything opens it.

Overview



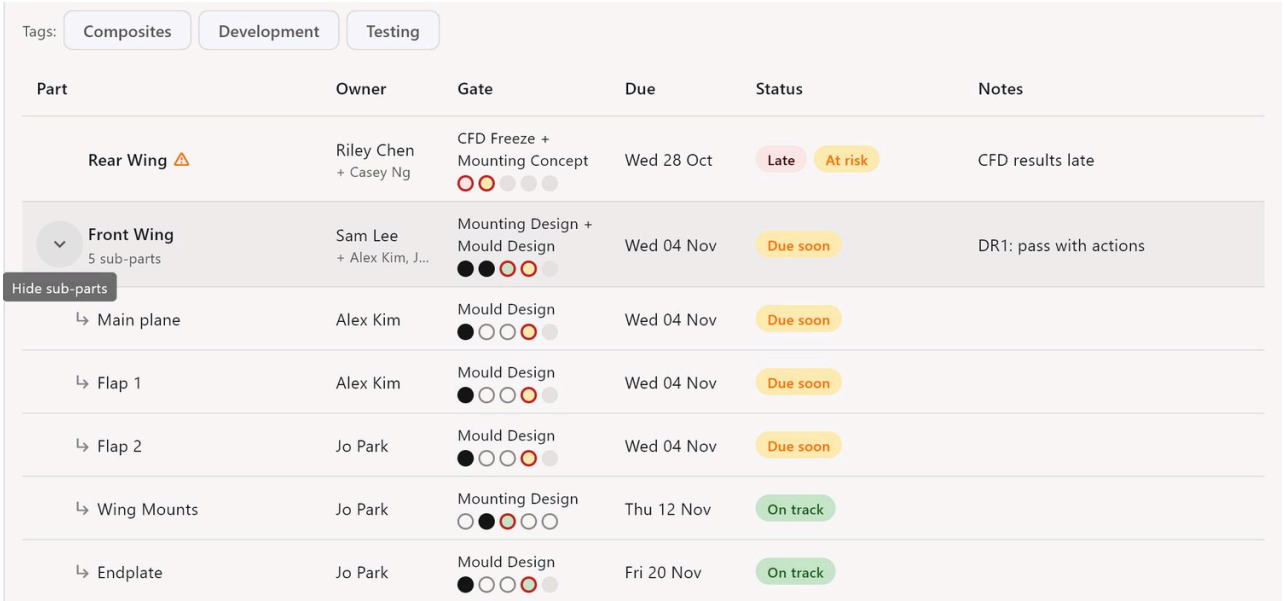
- **Subteam cards**: progress, plus counts of what's late, flagged, due soon or overdue. Click a card to open the subteam.
- **Needs attention**: late or flagged parts, overdue actions and key dates that are overdue or close. Start every meeting here.
- **Next 14 days**: gates, actions and key dates coming up.

My work



Pick your name once (it's remembered). You'll see the parts you own *or* help on, your open actions and the key dates you're responsible for, with anything late at the top. If your name is missing, ask your lead to spell it the same way everywhere.

A subteam page



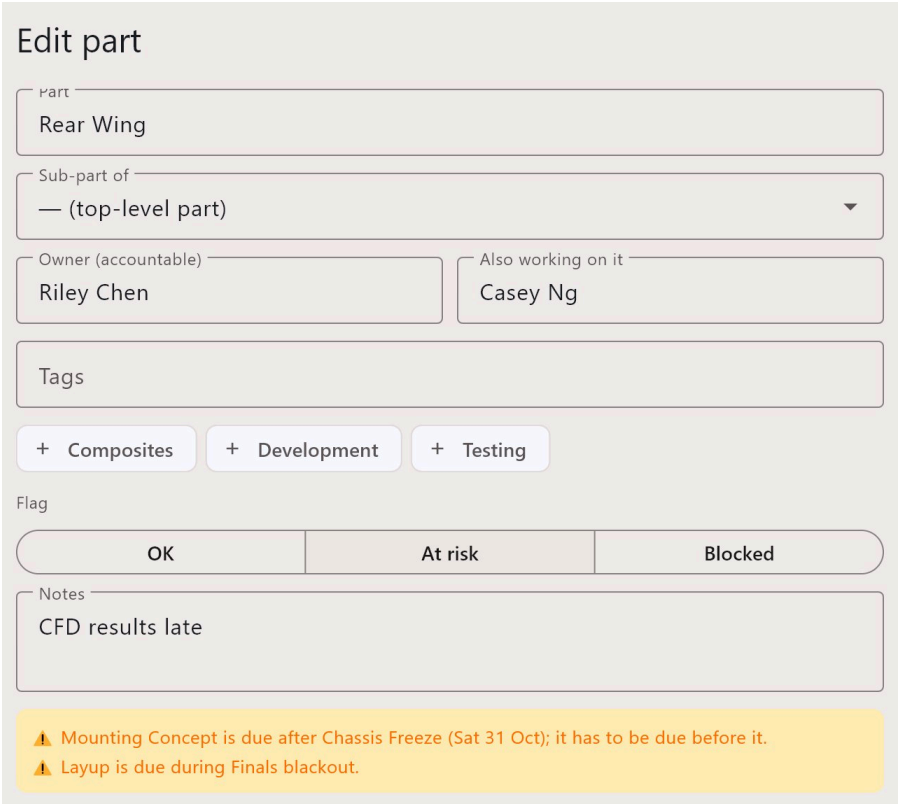
- Parts are sorted **problems first**. An assembly (e.g. Front Wing) shows its sub-parts collapsed: click › to expand. The line under its name says how many sub-parts need attention.
- **Gate column**: what the part is working on now. Gates can run in parallel, so there may be more than one.
- **Dots**, one per gate: **filled** = passed, **red ring** = being worked on, **hollow grey** = skipped (doesn't apply to this part), **faint** = waiting for an earlier gate.
- ⚠ next to a name: one of its dates breaks a gate rule (e.g. due after a freeze). Hover over it to see which.
- Under the owner: anyone else working on it. Under the name: its **tags**. Click a tag at the top to show only those parts, or type in the filter box (part, person, tag or note).

What the statuses mean

Status	Means
Late	a gate being worked on is past its due date
Due soon	a gate being worked on is due within 7 days
On track	due later than that
No date	the gates being worked on have no due date yet; give them one
Done	every gate is passed or skipped
At risk / Blocked	a flag set by the lead: might slip / can't move without help. Raise it at the meeting.

Updating a part (leads)

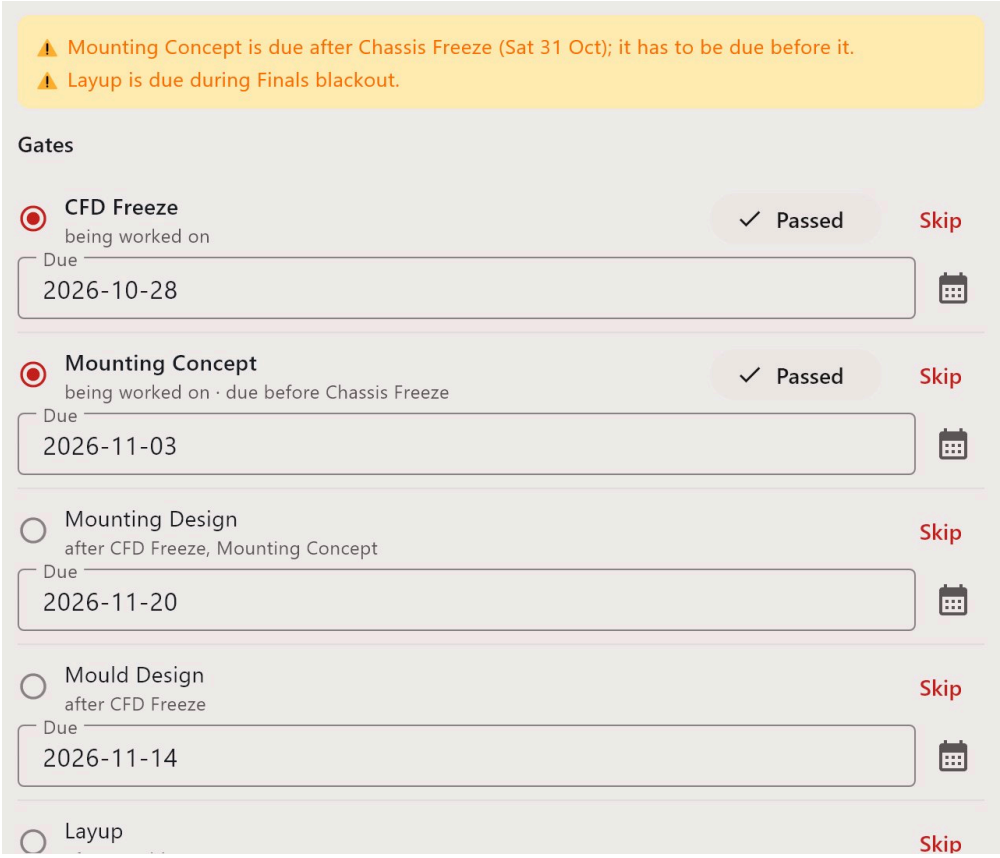
Click a part to open it. View-only members see the same window without the buttons.



- **Owner** is the one person accountable; **Also working on it** lists helpers (they'll see it in My work).
- **Tags**: type them comma-separated, or click a suggested one. Use *Development* for projects that aren't going on the car.
- **Flag**: *At risk* or *Blocked* puts the part under *Needs attention*. Add a one-line reason in **Notes**.
- **Sub-part of** puts it under an assembly; **Add sub-part** (bottom) creates one directly.
- The yellow box lists gate-rule problems with the dates you've entered. They're warnings, so you can still save.

Passing, skipping and saving (leads)

Further down the same window, each gate of the part has its own row:

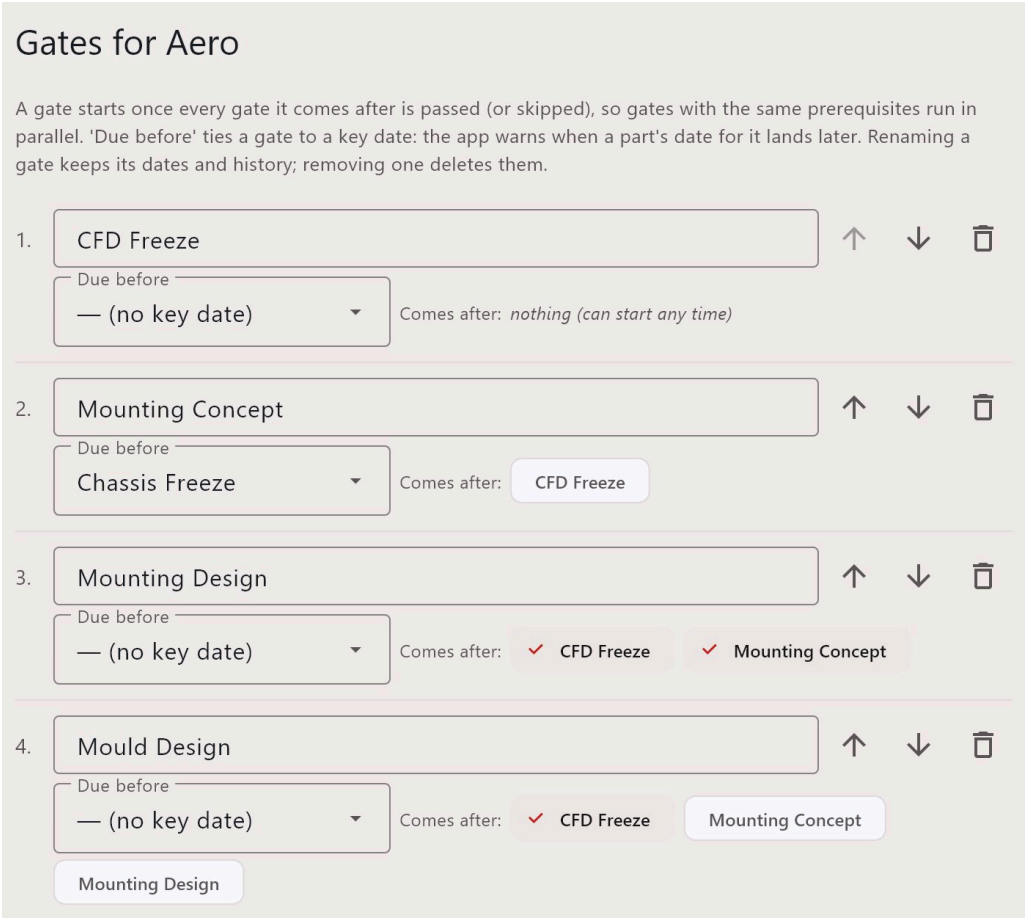


- Each gate has its own row and due date. On a gate being worked on, press **Passed** when it's done: it records today's date, which you can change if it was passed earlier. The app shows whether it was early or late.
- **Undo** un-passes a gate (and anything after it). **Skip** marks a gate that doesn't apply to this part (e.g. no mould for a bracket); **Unskip** brings it back.
- Nothing is saved until you press **Save**. **Cancel** throws the changes away.

"Edit failed." You don't have edit access to that file. The app switches it to view-only; ask the PM if you should have access.

"... was changed by someone else." Someone saved first. The app reloads their version; make your change again.

Gates and gate rules (leads)



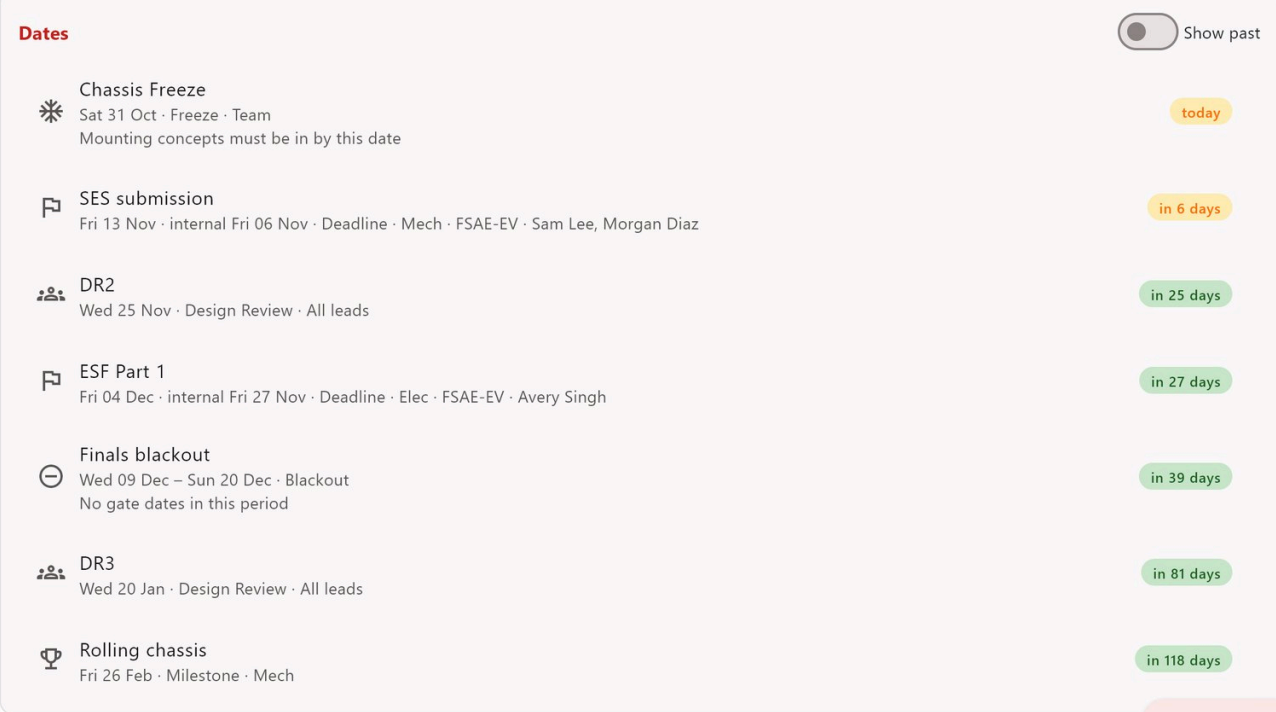
Edit gates (top of your subteam page) sets the gates your parts go through, in order.

- **Comes after**: a gate starts once every gate it comes after is passed or skipped. Gates with the same prerequisites run **in parallel**: here Mould Design only needs CFD Freeze, while Mounting Design needs CFD Freeze *and* Mounting Concept.
- **Due before**: ties a gate to a key date (e.g. Chassis Freeze); parts dated later get a ⚠. Gates dated inside a *Blackout* key date get one too.
- Renaming a gate keeps its dates and history; removing one deletes them. **Reset to default** restores the standard DR01 to DR03, Manufacturing, Testing.

Actions

Follow-ups from design reviews. On your subteam page, **Add action**: one owner, a due date, the part it's about and where it came from (e.g. DR2). Tick the box when it's done. Overdue actions appear under *Needs attention* and in the owner's My work.

Key dates and the calendar



- Competition deadlines, design reviews, milestones, freezes, blackouts and events. The PM adds and edits them.
- When there's an **internal deadline**, status and reminders follow it rather than the official date.
- People named on a key date see it in *My work*; it shows under *Needs attention* from 7 days out.
- The **Calendar** shows every gate, action and key date by month. Use the chips to hide subteams; ⏱ marks internal deadlines. Click a day to see everything on it.

The weekly routine

Before the leads meeting (leads, ~5 minutes): pass the gates you finished, fix any dates that moved, set flags with a reason, and tick off finished actions.

In the meeting (everyone): go through *Needs attention*, then *Next 14 days*. Record each design review's follow-ups as actions straight away, each with an owner and a due date.

Screenshots use made-up names and data.